Prepared for BlackRock

Aladdin Studio from the outside

What a prospect can see today, with receipts

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Independent analysis compiled from public sources. It was not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Aladdin Studio is in use, and BlackRock has described it the same way for three years. Almost everything a developer would want, though, sits behind a client login. The gap is distribution, not positioning.

54

Public API specifications in 11 PyPI packages, covering 301 operations

3,000

Citizen developers inside BlackRock writing Python or R against Aladdin, per its head of Studio engineering, 2025

4 of 16

Studio's score on an eight-criterion test of what an outside developer can reach

Source: asdk_plugin packages on PyPI[1]; Dave Woodhead on the Snowflake Data Cloud podcast[2]; the author's hands-on test, Exhibit 6.

The proof of use is outside BlackRock's channels. JPMorgan Chase paid $25.6 million for Aladdin in 2025, almost six times its 2017 level[3, 4]. A Janus Henderson engineer adapted the open-source SDK to the firm's API gateway, and BlackRock merged the changes[5, 6]. Royal London's chief executive credits the Snowflake implementation[7]. Inside BlackRock, Woodhead counts "3,000 citizen developers"[2].

From outside, a prospect can read one product page whose calls to action are "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"[8], install an SDK that needs a client host and a Studio token before any call succeeds[9], and unpack 54 specifications, every one tagged `Access.Internal` and, in the same file, given an access level of `Public`[1]. No executive has said "Studio" on 26 earnings calls since 2020[10], while BlackRock projects API calls to grow 17 times by 2030[11].

Four BlackRock speakers, from early 2024 to late 2025, describe Studio with the same three parts: APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud on Snowflake, and developer tools[12, 13, 14, 2]. That message reaches podcasts, webinars and one page, not investors, a public developer portal, or the AI tools that seven data providers already connect to[15, 16, 17]. Part 4 sets out five moves for the first 90 days and the eight internal numbers needed first.

How to read the receipts

Underlined text links to the document behind the fact. Each superscript points to the Source register at the back, which gives the grade, title, speaker and date. Each exhibit's source line starts with the grade of its main source.

■ **P** Primary document: an SEC filing, an API specification, a product page, GitHub or PyPI

■ **S** BlackRock speaker on the record: a recording, with the name and title as given

□ **T** Third-party report: trade press or a secondary summary

Method

Pulled. The 54 Swagger specifications inside BlackRock's 11 public `asdk_plugin` packages; 15 BlackRock product pages; 126 transcripts of recordings, 121 from BlackRock's own channels and partner stages (podcasts, Big Little Questions, webinar replays, client videos, conference talks) and five third-party tutorials; SEC filings for BlackRock, JPMorgan Chase and Janus Henderson; BlackRock's GitHub and PyPI pages.

Checked. Every number was recomputed from the files or read in the cited document. Every quotation was matched to its transcript; machine transcriptions are marked in the register.

Corrected. 58 specifications is 54 once the SDK's four utility APIs are set aside. A widely repeated "68 percent" survey figure was dropped because it could not be found in the report it is attributed to. "More than 2,000 citizen developers" is 3,000, and the figure counts BlackRock staff, not clients.

Part 1

What Studio is

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Its AI engineering lead put the scale this way at a LangChain conference in 2025: "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries"; the organization is "around 7,000 people, with over 4,000 of those being engineers," who maintain "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[18]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025, up 24 percent with Preqin[19]. BlackRock sells the platform as one engine with separate entry points, and Studio is the entry point for people who write code.

Exhibit 1. One core engine with separate entry points for each kind of buyer

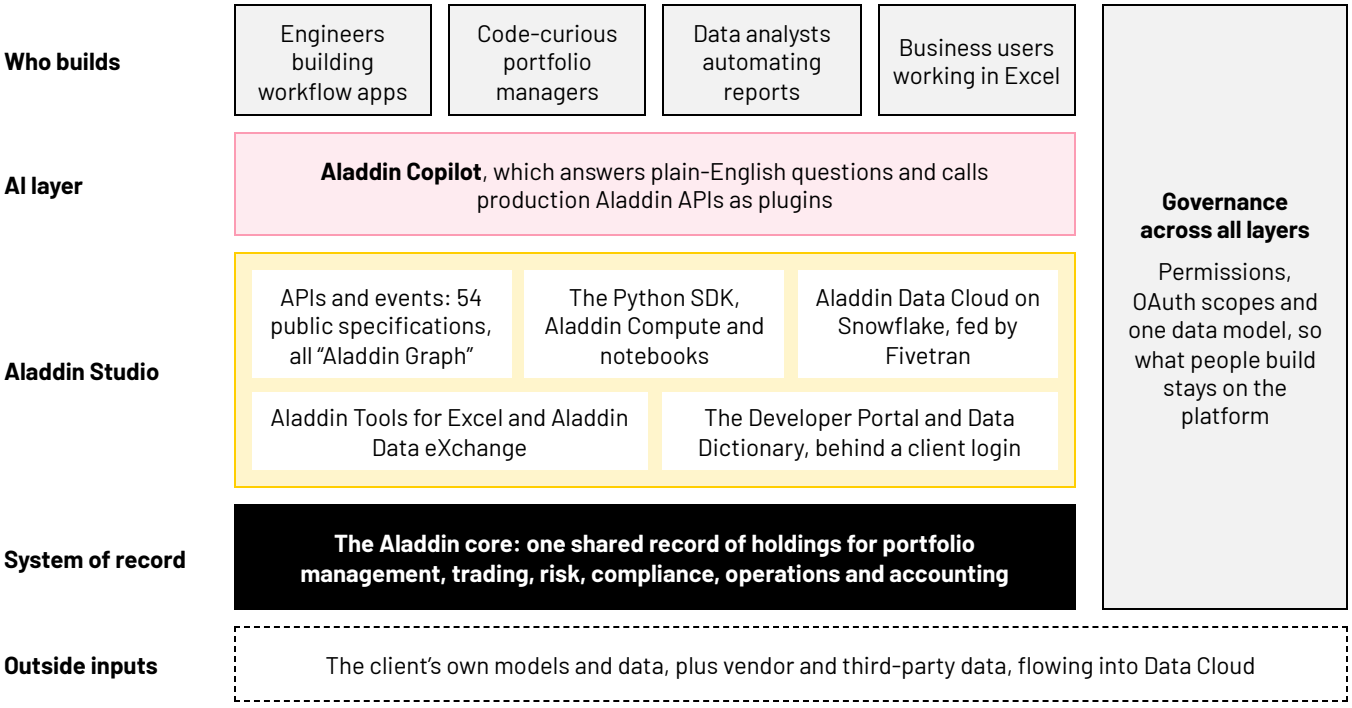
Product	What it does	Main users
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public markets, the same system BlackRock runs internally[18]	Asset managers, insurers, pension funds, banks
Aladdin Wealth	Portfolio risk analysis and proposals for advisors; its AI "auto commentary" tool launched in October 2025 with Morgan Stanley first[20]	Wealth managers and private banks
eFront	A private fund investment from due diligence through cash flows and reporting; folded Preqin into eFront Insight, with private credit analytics added in May 2026[21]	Investors in funds and fund managers
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer: APIs and events, a Python SDK, Aladdin Compute and Aladdin Data Cloud; "API-first", for "a professional engineer building new workflow applications, a code-curious portfolio manager extracting investment insights, or a data analyst automating reporting"[8]**	**Client engineers, data analysts, code-curious portfolio managers**
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data service on Snowflake that puts Aladdin and outside data in one place; sold as an add-on to Aladdin Enterprise[22]; Newman places it "part of Studio"[13]	Data teams
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant "now available to all Aladdin clients" that "will not give investment advice"[23]	All platform users
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance; the public accounting APIs cover configuration, valuations, lots and composites[1]	Asset managers and asset owners
Aladdin Provider	Connects custodians and administrators into a client's Aladdin; service providers pay BlackRock for its use[24]	Custodians and administrators

Source: BlackRock product pages[8, 23, 25]; Amazon press release, December 2025[22]; iShares prospectus[24]; the public specifications[1].

BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering, on Snowflake's podcast in November 2025. It has three parts.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> — Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, published November 11, 2025[2]

Exhibit 2. Studio sits between the people who build and the system of record



For illustrative purposes only. ■ Source: BlackRock Studio, APIs and Data Cloud pages[8, 26, 25]; the public specifications and SDK README[1, 9]; Woodhead[2]; Rosales and Valdez on the Copilot plugin registry[18].

Exhibit 3. Eight pieces, from read-and-write APIs to an Excel add-in

Piece	What it is, in plain words
APIs (Aladdin Graph)	Defined ways for a program to read and write Aladdin data. Every public specification carries an id of the form `agraph.<domain>.<segment>.<group>.v1.<API>`, so Aladdin Graph is the whole API layer, not one API[1]. The APIs page says there are "dozens," with more added regularly[26]. The 54 public specs include orders, trades, compliance rules, risk rules, security creation and ADC datasets[1].
Event-driven APIs	Aladdin tells a program when something happens instead of the program asking. Woodhead names "APIs events" as one pillar[2]; Goel's target is "every single transaction … via an event, via an API"[14]. No event specification is in the public packages[1].
Aladdin Data Cloud	A managed data store on Snowflake, with Fivetran moving the data; Goel gives the latency as "within 15 minutes"[14]. Woodhead: "hundreds of Snowflake accounts … tens of thousands of pipelines"[2].
Aladdin Compute	A hosted space where developers run Python next to their Aladdin data; the SDK has a run mode for "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions"[9].

Piece	What it is, in plain words
Aladdin SDK	An open-source Python library that handles login, retries, rate limits, pagination and long-running operations[9]. Eleven add-on packages, one per domain, are generated from the specifications by the plugin builder[27].
Investment research	A domain of five alpha APIs: research notes, engagements, analyst coverage, watchlists and screening criteria[1].
Aladdin Tools for Excel	An Excel add-in listed on the APIs page as a Studio resource, with Aladdin Data eXchange for bulk delivery; little public detail[26].
Developer Portal and Data Dictionary	The API catalog, framework guides, field dictionary, notebooks and code samples the APIs page describes. All sit behind a client login[26].

Source: BlackRock Studio and APIs pages[8, 26]; the 54 public specifications and SDK README[1, 9]; Woodhead[2] and Goel[14].

Exhibit 4. The public catalog: 54 specifications across 11 domains

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	11 domains, 11 PyPI packages

Source: the 54 Swagger 2.0 specifications inside the 11 `asdk_plugin` packages, version 2.0.0b3, on PyPI[1]. Counts recomputed by the author from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs (token, subscription, notification and a demo), which are not counted here.

The specifications say more than their count. Every one is tagged `Access.Internal`, a label BlackRock does not explain in public[1]. Posting an order takes `whatIf` and `runCompliance`, which defaults to true, and returns compliance violations inline[1]. Ten specifications expose a long-running-operations endpoint and 35 operations are flagged for it; the SDK polls them[9]. Risk exceptions and ADC datasets carry bitemporal fields; rule assignments and dataset releases name a four-eyes approval[1]. Every request carries an application key plus OAuth 2.0 scopes such as `trading.order_management.order.v1.Order:read`, and the client ID and secret come from the Studio UI[9].

Part 2

The public surface, mapped

Exhibit 5 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps, from first hearing about Studio to getting help, and records what is open at each step and what needs a client login. The pattern is the same at every step after the first two.

Exhibit 5. Six steps a prospect's developer takes, and where each one stops

Step	Open today	Behind a client login	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, webinar replays, client videos and conference talks on BlackRock's site and partner channels; a Fivetran write-up and a Microsoft recap	Nothing	Never Done[28], Big Little Questions[29], Woodhead[2], Rosales and Valdez[18]
Read	The Studio page: three benefit headings, "Create & automate," "Make Aladdin your own," "Align internally & externally," and three named users; the APIs page says "dozens of APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[8], APIs page[26]
See the catalog	54 specifications, visible only by unpacking the 11 PyPI add-on packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[1], APIs page[26]
Try	Nothing: no sandbox, trial or public test environment was found	Studio Compute, an API token or OAuth application "registered via Studio UI," the client's Aladdin host	SDK README[9]
Build	The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README; the plugin builder	Every call: the SDK needs a client host and credentials before any request succeeds	SDK README[9], PyPI history[30], plugin builder[27]
Get help	GitHub issues and pull requests on the SDK, which BlackRock engineers answer; the calls to action are "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"	Notebooks, code samples, support	Pull request 52[5], pull request 57[31], Studio page[8]

■ Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account, login or payment, October 2026.

The same gating shows in a scored comparison. On October 8, 2026, I tested how far a developer with no client relationship could get on 11 platforms, scoring eight criteria from 0 to 2[32, 33, 34]. Studio scored 4 of 16. Its open-source SDK is unique among the incumbent investment platforms tested[9], but documentation, a sandbox and a first call all require a login. The data and cloud platforms score higher because they sell to developers directly, so their rows are a reference point, not a like-for-like comparison.

Exhibit 6. Outside developer access, scored on eight criteria

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after signup or approval 0: None or blocked

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First call as a non-client	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action	Score
Investment platforms									
Bloomberg	1	0	1	1	1	0	0	1	5
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**4**
State Street	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	4
Arcesium	0	0	0	0	0	1	2	0	3
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1
Data and cloud platforms									
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	16
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	16
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1	12
FactSet	2	2	0	0	2	1	2	0	9
MSCI	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	2

Scoring: on each criterion, 2 means fully public or self-serve, 1 means partial, limited, or open only after a free signup or an approval, and 0 means none or blocked. For the AI connector, 2 means an MCP server or connector that outside AI tools can use, 1 means one that is announced or in limited release, and 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform.

Source: the author's hands-on test of each platform's public pages[8, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 17], with no accounts, logins or payments, October 8, 2026. Bloomberg, Clearwater and MSCI may be underrated because some of their pages blocked automated access.

The richest public source on Studio is spoken, not written. The 126 recordings pulled for this document hold 39 podcast episodes, 12 webinar replays, 15 Big Little Questions episodes, three client-story videos, two Uncharted episodes, 32 eFront videos and a handful of conference talks and partner videos[28, 29]. Five BlackRock speakers define Studio on the record, and their titles are the ones the recordings give.

Exhibit 7. The five BlackRock speakers who define Studio on the record

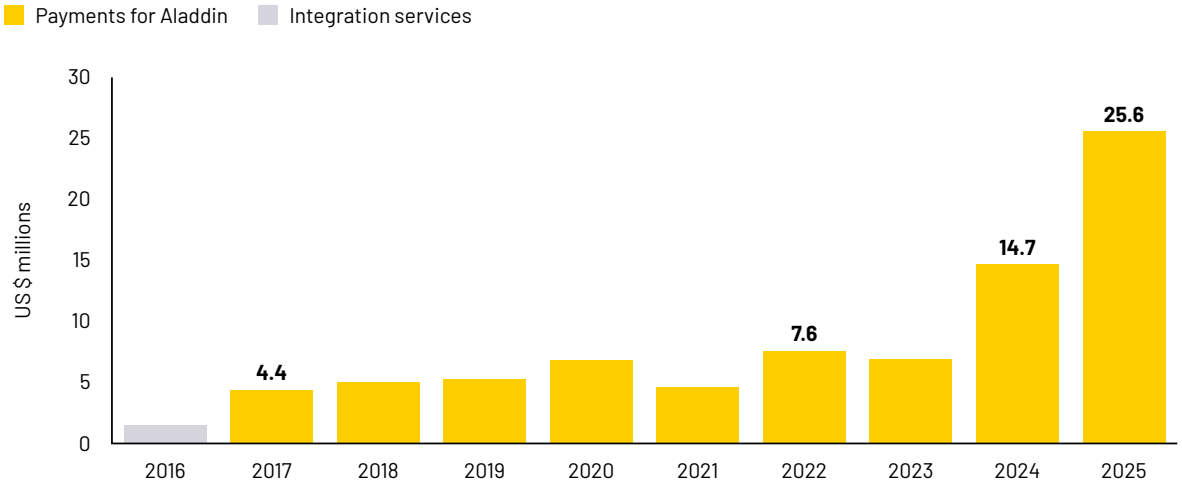
Speaker	Title, as given	What they add	Where
Dave Woodhead	Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio	The three-pillar definition; 3,000 internal citizen developers; "hundreds of Snowflake accounts"	Snowflake podcast, Nov 2025[2]
Richard Newman	General Manager, Aladdin Studio	Data Cloud is "part of Studio"; analytics APIs "releasing soon … all part of the Studio umbrella"	Never Done, Jan 2025[13]
Diwakar Goel	Global Head of Data, Aladdin	Every transaction "via an event, via an API"; Data Cloud "within 15 minutes of latency"; 3,000 people in the citizen-developer bracket	Pensions webinar, 2025[14]
Kunal Khara	Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product	"The Aladdin studio estate" as a 2024 focus: programmatic access "at machine scale"	Awards interview, early 2024[12]
Jeff Miller	Managing Director, Global Head of Data Platform and Product Engineering	Data Cloud replaced "flat files … FTP and related transfers"	Snowflake video, undated[39]

Source: the recordings cited in the Where column. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; three of the five are machine transcriptions, marked in the register.

1. Studio is in use, and the proof sits in other firms' filings and code

BlackRock's Studio page names no client as building on Studio's APIs or SDK[8]; its own client video has Royal London's chief executive crediting the Snowflake implementation[7]. A full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no company filing that mentions "Aladdin Studio"[40]. The evidence of use is in what other firms pay, file and commit. JPMorgan Chase reports its Aladdin payments in its proxy statement every year, the only client found that does so over this many years[4]. Payments stayed between $4.4 million and $7.6 million from 2017 to 2023, then rose to $14.7 million in 2024 and $25.6 million in 2025[3].

Exhibit 8. JPMorgan Chase payments to BlackRock for Aladdin, US$ millions



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A), filed 2017 to 2026, by year of payment[4, 3]. The payments may include more than a client license: JPMorgan is also a custodian, and in 2016 it said it was connecting to Aladdin to serve custody clients on the platform[41]; that report is trade press, not a JPMorgan or BlackRock document.

In December 2025 a Janus Henderson engineer submitted two changes to the open-source SDK: one lets it send API calls to a different address, the other adds custom headers such as a subscription key, both for firms that route Aladdin calls through an enterprise gateway like Azure API Management[5, 6]. The BlackRock engineer who co-wrote the SDK's launch post merged them, and the code is on the main branch[42, 43]. All six commits carry the same author line:

```
From 1c1bd2559e4e4da2591f13dccfd7db6c2f9dc68c Mon Sep 17 00:00:00 2001
From: [redacted] <[redacted]@janushenderson.com>
Date: Mon, 1 Dec 2025 16:53:28 +0000
Subject: [PATCH 1/3] Added ability to add additional HTTP headers.
```

View the raw commit on GitHub: blackrock/aladdinsdk, commit 1c1bd25 →[44]

The timing fits Janus Henderson's 10-K, which says the firm chose in the third quarter of 2025 to move its investment management system to Aladdin, a "complex, multi-year initiative"[45]. The SDK's contributor history shows no code from any other company[46]. Inside BlackRock, Woodhead counts "3,000 citizen developers in business engineers that are interacting with Aladdin using Python or using R" and adds "I think that number has probably peaked"[2]; Goel gives the same figure[14].

> **What it means for go-to-market.** The references exist, but none is BlackRock's to use: a proxy statement, a 10-K and a commit are facts a prospect can find, not stories a seller can tell. The first job is to turn one migration into a named build story with the client's consent.

2. BlackRock's own growth story is APIs, yet Studio is never named to investors

At its 2025 Investor Day, BlackRock projected that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17 times by 2030, against four times for model portfolios, two times for portfolios and 1.3 times for trade allocations; the slide gave no starting number[11]. API use is the activity the Studio page describes[8]. Yet across 26 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the second quarter of 2026, no executive said "Studio"[10], and a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide is the only other investor mention found[47]. BlackRock's 10-K reports technology services revenue and annual contract value, with nothing on Studio[19].

Exhibit 9. Mentions of Studio terms on 26 BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026

Term	Mentions	Context
Studio	**0**	**One line on a 2023 Investor Day slide is the only other investor mention found[47]**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[48] and Q4 2024[49], as an add-on sold with Aladdin Enterprise
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[50]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[51]
Citizen developer	0	Never
Agent	0	Never

Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q2 2026[10]. Counts are the author's tally. Zero counts are reliable; other counts are approximate.

The 10-K describes the economics without the product. BlackRock's FY2025 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate, and can also depend on the number of subscriptions, implementation go-lives, and delivery and support[19]. API calls, the measure BlackRock projects to grow fastest, appear in none of those terms[11].

The silence is not for lack of material. BlackRock's product head told an awards interviewer in early 2024 that "the Aladdin studio estate … is going to this year be a major, major unlock," because users want to work with data "on a programmatic basis at machine scale"[12]. Its trading product marketing head describes "a burgeoning community of individuals saying 'I need that in the form of an API'"[52]. Those lines live on podcasts and award videos, not in the materials an analyst or a chief technology officer reads.

> **What it means for go-to-market.** The 17-times projection is Studio's number without Studio's name. A reportable measure, agreed with investor relations and product, would let the investor story and the product story point at the same thing.

3. The developer front door is a sales conversation, not a signup

The public Studio page works like a brochure: its calls to action are "Book a meeting" and "Download the brochure"[8]. The APIs page mentions developer guides, notebooks and code samples but links to none[26]. The one open artifact is the SDK, and the SDK is a key without a door: the README says the client ID and secret "can be sourced from Studio UI by creating a OAuth application under a Project," and an API token is "registered via Studio UI"[9]. A developer at a prospect firm can install it and read its code, and cannot make a call.

Exhibit 10. The top of Studio's developer funnel is a sales conversation, not a signup

Public	Behind a client login
Marketing pages on blackrock.com/aladdin[8, 26]	The Studio Developer Portal[26]
The BlackRock Engineering blog on Medium[42]	Full API documentation and the API framework guides[26]
The open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README[9, 30]	The Data Dictionary and downloadable notebooks[26]
The 54 specifications, by unpacking the add-on packages[1]	API tokens, OAuth applications, Compute sessions and Data Cloud[9]
Podcasts, webinar replays and conference talks[28, 2]	Rate limits, SLAs, pricing and the Studio UI itself

Source: BlackRock's Studio and APIs pages[8, 26]; the SDK README and PyPI history[9, 30]; the engineering blog[42].

The README shows who the SDK is built for. It documents three run modes, "a developer's local machine," "Aladdin Studio Compute sessions" and a test mode; it stores a prompted password in the operating system's credential manager; and it already carries settings for firms that consume "the Aladdin APIs via an enterprise API management platform such as Azure API Management," the case the Janus Henderson pull requests extended[9, 5]. These are the needs of a client's engineering team, not of a prospect reading the page.

The SDK itself is a beta. It has had 14 releases since May 2024, all alpha or beta, with the core at 2.0.0b10 in July 2026 and the add-ons at 2.0.0b3[30, 1]. None installs on Python 3.13, because each pins an old Snowflake library, and the SDK conflicts with the official MCP toolkit; an outside fix was merged in August 2026 and has not shipped[31]. The scored test in Exhibit 6 puts Studio at 4 of 16, level with State Street and one point behind Bloomberg[33]. Gating is a reasonable choice for a platform sold to large institutions on long contracts. It does mean the curious engineer at a prospect, the person Khara describes as wanting access "at machine scale," reads nothing until a meeting is booked[12].

> **What it means for go-to-market.** The first public API reference, even a read-only one for a few stable domains, would move the developer's first hour from a sales call to a page. A stable SDK release would give that page something that installs.

4. AI tools are the new front door, and seven data providers already have one

MCP is the common standard AI assistants use to pull data from other systems[53]. Seven providers a Studio buyer also talks to now offer a connector or an MCP server. LSEG had 90 customers connected to its MCP server by April 2026, according to a secondary summary of its results slides[54, 16]. No public connector for Aladdin was found on BlackRock's product pages or GitHub[8, 55].

Exhibit 11. Seven data and platform providers let outside AI tools pull their data; no public Aladdin equivalent was found

Provider	What is public	Receipt
FactSet	An MCP server for its data, which FactSet calls the first in its market	FactSet press release[15]
LSEG	A collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server; 90 customers connected by April 2026	LSEG press release[16]; Investing.com summary[54]
MSCI	"AI connectors" to its proprietary data	MSCI press release[17]
Arcesium	AI features in Aquata, and an AI platform announcement	Arcesium press releases[56, 38]
S&P Global	Credit Ratings added to its AI Data Portal, September 2026	S&P Global press release[57]
Snowflake	A documented MCP server for Cortex Agents	Snowflake documentation[58]
Databricks	Managed MCP servers, documented	Databricks documentation[59]
Aladdin	**None found. A Forward Deploy Engineer posting for Aladdin Data names "Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI agents, and Copilot extensions"**	**BlackRock Careers[60]**

Source: the press releases, documentation and job posting in the Receipt column, as of October 2026. The LSEG customer count is from a secondary summary[54].

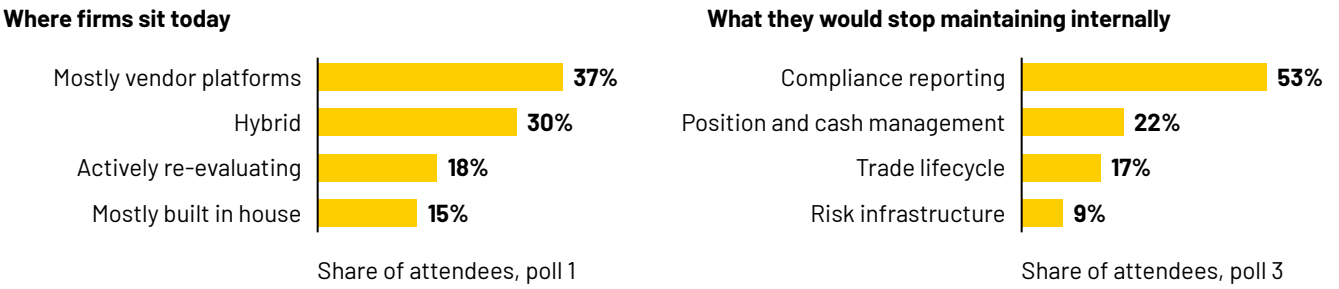
Inside the platform, the connector already exists in a different form. Aladdin Copilot is "now available to all Aladdin clients" and "will not give investment advice or respond to questions outside Aladdin platform boundaries"[23]. Its engineers describe a plugin registry with "couple of thousands agents and tools", where the first way a team onboards is "to define a tool as kind of mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[18]. Copilot's tools are Studio's APIs. Microsoft's Adrian Crockett put the dependency in one line on BlackRock's podcast: "There's no copilot without plug-ins"[61]. BlackRock's AI product head says the team is making sure "the data model itself is structured for agentic use cases"[62].

> **What it means for go-to-market.** The next prospect's first API call may come from an AI assistant rather than a notebook. A connector that exposes a governed subset of the same APIs Copilot already calls would meet that buyer where FactSet, LSEG and MSCI already stand.

5. Buyers say they want a core platform plus their own builds

BlackRock's own Build vs. Buy webinar polled its attendees. In the first poll, 37 percent said they run "mostly vendor platforms," 30 percent "hybrid," 18 percent were "actively reevaluating" and 15 percent were "mostly built in house"[63]. Asked what is driving the decision, "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent, with cost and speed to market tied behind it[63]. Asked what they would stop maintaining internally, 53 percent chose compliance reporting[63]. The host read from the slide that 60 to 70 percent of technology cost sits in "maintenance of current systems," and the Alpha FMC panellist said a transformation runs "roughly 12 to 18 months"[63].

Exhibit 12. What attendees of BlackRock's Build vs. Buy webinar said



Source: poll results as read out on the Build vs. Buy webinar replay, published captions[63]. Attendee counts were not stated. Poll 2, on what is driving the decision, put "AI and data demands" at 42 percent, with cost and speed to market tied.

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> — Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[63]

The market is moving the same way. SimCorp announced wins at AllianceBernstein in February 2026 and Pictet in May 2026; AllianceBernstein keeps its "specialized in-house technology," and Pictet connects its own tools to SimCorp One by API[64, 65]. BlackRock's August 2026 insight says "Build vs buy is no longer a binary question"[66]. Studio is the product that answers that question for Aladdin, and the webinar did not name it.

> **What it means for go-to-market.** The buyer is asking for the API suite in the RFP. The answer should be a document a prospect can read before the RFP, with the catalog, the connectors and a named client who built on it.

6. The public message is consistent; the distribution is not

Four BlackRock speakers, across two years and four venues, describe Studio with the same three parts. Woodhead names them outright[2]. Newman places Data Cloud "part of Studio" and analytics APIs "all part of the Studio umbrella"[13]. Goel describes events, APIs and a near-real-time data store, and adds that BlackRock wants "to start exposing some of the software and application that we're building"[14]. Khara calls it programmatic access to data, reporting and dashboards[12]. The 2026 Studio Developer posting calls Studio "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[67], and the product page says "Make Aladdin your own"[8].

Exhibit 13. Four BlackRock speakers, 2024 to 2025, and the three pillars each names

Speaker, date	What they said	APIs and events	Data Cloud	Developer tools
Kunal Khara, early 2024	"More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis at machine scale, over and above what they get through our front end applications"[12]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Richard Newman, Jan 2025	"The Aladdin data cloud specifically … which is part of Studio"; "we're releasing soon the ability to actually access those analytic APIs … That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[13]	**Yes**	**Yes**	–
Diwakar Goel, 2025	"Every single transaction that happens should be available and accessible to you via an event, via an API"; ADC as "a near real time data store … within 15 minutes of latency"; exposing "the software and application that we're building"[14]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**
Dave Woodhead, Nov 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake … And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools"[2]	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

Source: the four recordings cited[12, 13, 14, 2]. Quotations are verbatim from the transcripts; Khara, Goel and Woodhead are machine or auto-caption transcriptions, marked in the register.

Where the message appears is the problem. It appears on podcasts, in webinar replays and on one product page[28, 63, 8]. It does not appear on an earnings call[10], in a public developer portal[26], in an SDK release that installs on current Python[30], or in a connector an outside AI tool can use[55]. The fall 2026 Aladdin Client Forum promised a first look at "where Aladdin goes next," to an audience of clients[68]. The positioning has held for three years. The channels have not changed with it.

> **What it means for go-to-market.** Marketing does not need a new message. It needs the existing one in four places it is missing: investor materials, a public reference, a stable release and an AI connector, in that order of cost.

Part 4

What I would do, and what I would need

Each move answers one finding. Product owns what gets built and when; marketing owns positioning, launches, client stories and sales enablement. Every capability would be labeled live or roadmap, with a quarter, before sales hears it; the product manager checks each message for accuracy, engineering checks technical claims and compliance checks the final version.

Exhibit 14. Five moves over 90 days and the two quarters after

Move	First 90 days	Following two quarters	Marketing owns	Product owns	Measure
Client build stories (Finding 1)	Shortlist clients moving onto Aladdin; secure one consent; draft the first story	Three named stories, one per persona on the Studio page	Finding, writing, legal review, placement	Client introductions; the engineering detail	Named references; deals where one was used
A reportable Studio measure (Finding 2)	Propose two candidate measures with investor relations, built on the API-call projection	One measure in earnings materials and in sales decks	The story around the number	A number that can be reported	Studio cited in earnings materials
A public API reference (Finding 3)	Decide with product what can be public; publish a getting-started guide for two stable domains	A public reference for the stable specifications; a first-call tutorial	The guide, the pages around it, the launch	The scope decision; technical review of every page	Developer access score; prospects who reach a first call
A stable SDK release (Finding 3)	Agree a release date; plan the launch	Ship 2.0; tell clients, partners and sales	Launch plan, release notes, partner briefing	The merged dependency fix; current Python support	Clean installs; a first stable release
An Aladdin AI connector (Finding 4)	Size the launch; position against FactSet, LSEG and MSCI; brief sales on what exists today	Launch a governed connector on the APIs Copilot already calls	Positioning, launch tiering, enablement	Scope and timing, on the Forward Deploy Engineer work[60]	Connector available; clients connected

■ Source: the author's proposals, built on Findings 1 to 6. The connector move builds on BlackRock's Forward Deploy Engineer posting, which names MCP[60], and on the plugin registry its engineers describe[18].

Launches would be sized in three tiers agreed with product, from a full campaign to release notes. Before any of this, eight questions need internal data that no public source holds.

Exhibit 15. Eight questions for internal data

Question	What the answer would decide
How many clients have active API credentials or a Data Cloud instance, and how has that changed since 2024?	The baseline for every measure in Exhibit 14
Is a migration the main moment clients start building on Studio?	Whether to lead with clients moving onto Aladdin
Which clients would agree to be named, and what usually stops them?	How soon client stories can start
What could a non-client be allowed to see without a login?	How much of an API reference can be public
What does the `Access.Internal` tag on every public specification mean, and does it limit what can be documented?	Whether the public catalog is the public reference
Which builds by BlackRock's own 3,000 citizen developers could become client stories, and what approvals would they need?	Whether internal builds can serve as early proof
How will clients connect their own AI tools to Aladdin, and is the Forward Deploy Engineer work the path?	The scope and timing of a connector launch
Where does adoption stall most: awareness, the first API call, or getting a build into production?	Where marketing spends first: public content, self-serve help or client success

Source: the author's questions, to test this document's findings against BlackRock's internal data. Question 5 refers to the tag on the public specifications[1].

On method: every claim in this document was checked against the document or recording it cites, and every number carries a date. Generative AI tools were used to pull pages, unpack packages and transcribe recordings. The reading, the scoring and the judgement were done by hand.

Source register

Numbered in order of first citation and grouped by grade. P is a primary document; S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with the name and title as the recording gives them; T is a third-party report. "Machine transcription" means a local transcription of the downloaded audio; "auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. In both, names and jargon can be mis-heard, and only caption misspellings of proper names were corrected inside quotations.

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About this document

Independent analysis compiled from public sources: BlackRock product pages, SEC filings, public code and packages on GitHub and PyPI, press releases, job postings, and transcripts of BlackRock recordings. It was not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit gives another date. Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Source register, which gives the grade, the title, the speaker and the date of every source.

Three corrections were made against earlier drafts of this research: 58 API specifications became 54 once the SDK's four utility APIs were set aside; a widely repeated "68 percent" survey figure was dropped because it could not be found in the report it is attributed to; and "more than 2,000 citizen developers" became 3,000, counted inside BlackRock rather than among clients.

The moves and questions in Part 4 are the author's proposals, based on the findings in Part 3.

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